

Nursena Ataseven

n.ataseven@rug.nl

Education

University of Groningen | Groningen, the Netherlands Sep 2023 – present

PhD Candidate, Advisors: Prof. Dr. Elkan G. Akyürek & Dr. Wouter Kruijne

PhD Trainee at the Research School of Behavioural and Cognitive Neurosciences (BCN)

Leibniz Research Institute for Working Environment and Sep 2024 – Sep 2025

Human Factors | Dortmund, Germany

Visiting Researcher, Advisor: Dr. Daniel Schneider

Sabancı University | Istanbul, Turkey Sep 2020 – June 2023

MSc Cognitive Psychology, Advisor: Dr. Eren Günseli

MEF University | Istanbul, Turkey Oct 2016 – June 2020

BA Psychology

Publications (and Preprints)

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. (2026, preprint). Mentally transformed representations in memory are linked to their originals.

<https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.09.10.750562>

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. (2026, preprint). Diffuse predictions stabilize and reshape the neural code during working memory encoding. *bioRxiv*.

<https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.02.23.707359>

Ataseven, N., Algin, E., Yücel, D., Güler, B., Todorova, L., Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. (2026). Memory reactivation levels remain unaffected by anticipated interference. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience*, 1–12. <https://doi.org/10.1162/jocn.a.2625>

Yılmaz, Y., **Ataseven, N.**, Kruijne, W., Akyürek, E., & Günseli, E. (2026). Passive but accessible: Studied information is not actively stored in working memory, yet attended regardless of anticipated load. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience*, 38(9), 1721–1734.

<https://doi.org/10.1162/jocn.a.2619>

Ataseven, N., Ünver, N., & Günseli, E. (2023). How does divided attention hinder different stages of episodic memory retrieval?. *Current Research in Behavioral Sciences*, 100139.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.crbeha.2023.100139>

Yucel, D., **Ataseven, N.**, Todorova, L., Güler, B., Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. (2023, preprint). Increased reliance on long-term memory when anticipating attentional guidance. *PsyArXiv*.

<https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/cs9qa>

Peker, M., Atar, H. Ö., & **Ataseven, N.** (2017). A review on interpersonal distance: Culture, gender, power, and directions for future research. *The British Psychological Society North East Branch Bulletin*, 6, 8-17.

Ongoing Research

Writing Stage

Özdemir, Ş., **Ataseven N.**, Kruijne W., Akyürek E. G., & Schneider, D. Key features of motor code formation in working memory.

Data Analysis Stage

Ataseven N., Brady, T. F., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. G. Bidirectional relationship between statistical regularity learning and attention.

Özdemir, Ş., **Ataseven N.**, Kruijne, W., Akyürek, E. G., & Schneider, D. Representational shift from sensory input to action plans in working memory.

Ataseven, N., Günseli, E., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. G. Anticipation of attentional demands modulates task performance through allocation of spatial attention.

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Ataseven, N., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. G. How does interference influence prioritised and unprioritised information?

Invited Talks

University of Cambridge, the MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit (To be presented, 2026)

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Neural representations underlying mental and physical transformation

Bern University of Applied Sciences, AFC Lab Talk Series (Dr. Meike Ramon), 2026

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Mentally rotated representations are linked to their originals. Video recording:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/16krOS3_InpM-JKMLYKa4v7DKGxok7C8L/view?usp=sharing

University of Würzburg, the Research Seminar, 2024

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Prior information shapes representations in visual working memory.

Conference Presentations

Talks

Annual Working Memory Symposium, 2026 (Blitz)

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Mental rotation products are bound to their initially encoded originals: maintained together and dropped together.

NVP Winter Conference organized by Dutch Society for Brain and Cognition, 2025

Symposium: Computational and neural mechanisms of prediction

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Prior information about upcoming stimulus influences stimulus representation at encoding

Annual Working Memory Symposium, 2025 (Blitz)

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Revealing the effect of prior information on neural representations in WM.

Annual Working Memory Symposium, 2024 (Blitz)

Ataseven, N., Günseli, E., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. Attentional allocation to target memories when anticipating distractors.

Annual Working Memory Symposium, 2023

Ataseven, N., Todorova, L., Yücel, D., Güler, B., Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. The effect of anticipated interference, memory load, and long-term memory availability on working memory reactivation.

Annual Working Memory Symposium, 2022

Ataseven, N., Todorova, L., Yücel, D., Güler, B., Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. Information available in long-term memory is reactivated in working memory regardless of anticipated perceptual interference.

Posters

Cognitive Neuroscience Society Conference, 2026

Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. Diffuse predictions reshape WM representations at encoding

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Vision Sciences Society, 2025

Ataseven N., Özdemir Ş., Schneider D., Kruijne W., & Akyurek E. G. Revealing the effect of regularities on representations in visual working memory. <https://doi.org/10.1167/jov.25.9.2625>

NVP Winter Conference organized by Dutch Society for Brain and Cognition, 2023

Ataseven, N., Kruijne W., & Akyürek E. G. The role of activity-silent working memory in protection against distraction.

European Society for Cognitive Psychology, 2023

Ataseven, N., Todorova, L., Yücel, D., Güler, B, Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. Working memory takes over long-term memory when anticipating perceptual interference.

Professional Service

Symposium Chair, “Computational and Neural Mechanisms of Prediction” at the NVP Winter Conference, 2023.

Speakers: Dr. Eelke Spaak, Dr. Darinka Trübutschek, Prof. Floris de Lange.

Organizer, Experimental Psychology Meetings 2025-2026, University of Groningen

Peer Reviewer, Memory & Cognition, Acta Psychologica Sinica

Teaching Experience

Lecturer, University of Groningen Sep 2023 - present

- Research Practicum
- Responsibilities:
 - Guided and evaluated students as they wrote their first scientific paper.
- Academic Skills
 - Gave a year-round course focused on development of academic skills.
 - Guided and evaluated students through oral presentations, essay writing, and a literature review.
- Bachelor Thesis
 - Supervised a group of Bachelor’s students throughout the thesis-writing process.
- Statistics III
 - Responsibilities:
 - Held office hours and supported students with statistical analysis assignments.
 - Graded students’ assignments and provided feedback.

Teaching Assistant, Sabancı University

Sep 2020 – Sep 2023

- PSY304: Research Methods and Statistics for Psychology II
- PSY316: Attention

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Scholarships

Full scholarship granted by Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey (TUBITAK) Sep 2020 – Jan 2023

BIDEB 2232 International Fellowship for Outstanding Researchers Programme

Full tuition scholarship granted by Sabancı University Sep 2016 – June 2020

Full tuition scholarship granted by MEF University Sep 2016 – June 2020

Awards

Yale Wu Tsai Institute Travel Award for attending CNS 2026 (500\$)

<https://www.cogneurosociety.org/past-award-winners/>

Skills

Programming: MATLAB, R, Python

Toolboxes: Psychtoolbox, EEGLAB, ERPLAB, Fieldtrip

Data acquisition: EEG

References

Prof. Dr. Elkan Akyürek

PhD Supervisor

University of Groningen

e.g.akyurek@rug.nl

Dr. Wouter Kruijne

PhD Supervisor

University of Groningen

w.kruijne@rug.nl

PD. Dr. Daniel Schneider

Collaborator/Research Visit Supervisor

Leibniz Research Centre for Working Environment and Human Factors

schneiderd@ifado.de

Asst. Prof. Dr. Eren Günseli

MSc Supervisor

Sabancı University

eren.gunseli@sabanciuniv.edu